

Fall- -44
DAY

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GERMAN

B-17 Pilot Sights Round Ball
During Daylight Bombing Mission over Germany
(A new case)

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Lt. [REDACTED] was flying a B-17 bomber in the early afternoon during the Fall of 1944 when this sighting took place. He was part of the [REDACTED]th Bomb Group, [REDACTED]th Squadron at the time and was over central Germany (from England) at an estimated altitude of about 35,000 feet with thirty five other bombers. He told me yesterday that the sky ahead was clear and calm at the time; he and the cockpit crewmen (four per airplane) of every other airplane in the group spotted a single, round, whitish (or translucent) object at their altitude some unknown distance ahead of them.² It was definitely above the distant horizon and was about as large in angle as one's little fingernail (viewed at arm's length)³. For the next five (5) minutes they all watched it but it didn't do anything. The squadron leader ordered a gentle right-hand bank by all aircraft and the unidentified aerial phenomenon (UAP) moved to the right at the same time, maintaining the same relative position in front of the group of airplanes at all times. Then when the squadron banked left again to their original heading so did the UAP. There was a very negligible time lag between the squadron's heading change and the UAP's position change. Eventually the object just disappeared (instantaneously).

Upon landing after their bombing mission Lt. [REDACTED] and his co-pilot were debriefed by Air Force intelligence as were other aircrew men on that mission. He didn't know how many were debriefed specifically on this matter. He did recall that his (with his co-pilot) interview lasted only about fifteen (15) minutes. He was never informed of what intelligence personnel learned and he heard nothing more about the matter.

He said that no electro-magnetic effects, radio interference or air turbulence was experienced on board his airplane during the sighting. He also thought that the object was already present in the sky and just happened to look in the right direction to see it, i.e., he didn't notice it because it traveled into his field of vision. Its edge was quite sharply defined and he saw no contrail or smoke behind the object. It never changed in size, shape, or color throughout the sighting and was brighter than the sky background. He has not seen anything unexplainable before or since.

¹ Now in his 80s and in good health.

² There could have been as many as one hundred forty four (144) eye witnesses to this event according to the witness.

³ This is equivalent to about fifty (50) min. arc assuming nail width = 0.38" and arm reach = 26."

[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]

Dear colleagues,

With this letter you will find attached a one (1) page summary report of an interview I had last night with the captain of a B-17 over Germany back in the Fall of 1944. His memory was sharp as a tack. I couldn't locate any corrolary reports for the [REDACTED] Bomb Group, [REDACTED] Squadron in my AIRCAT files which (for me) make this a new report. If you know of any I would appreciate learning of them.

Please feel free to post it, republish it, whatever - as long as you don't change any facts and insert my name in a footnote as the investigator. Enjoy!

Dick Haines

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[REDACTED]